

**BLUE PLANTAIN LILY***Hosta "Halycon"*  
F: Asparagaceae

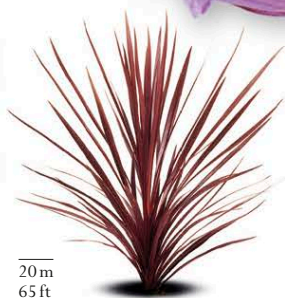
This hybrid is one of many garden varieties of *Hosta*, a genus of shade-tolerant plants native to N.E. Asia.

45 cm  
18 in45 cm  
18 in**ENGLISH BLUEBELL***Hyacinthoides non-scripta*  
F: Asparagaceae

Native to W. Europe, this bulb-forming plant sometimes carpets whole woodland floors with blue flowers in spring.

80 cm  
32 in**COMMON FRINGE LILY***Thysanotus tuberosus*  
F: Asparagaceae

Native to S.E. Australia, this narrow-leaved plant has fringe-petalled flowers that each open for only one day.

20 m  
65 ft**CABBAGE TREE***Cordyline australis*  
F: Asparagaceae

One of New Zealand's most common trees, shown here as a young plant, the cabbage tree develops a sturdy trunk topped by dense tufts of narrow leaves and showy spikes of white flowers.

**PALE YELLOW-EYED GRASS***Sisyrinchium striatum*  
F: Iridaceae

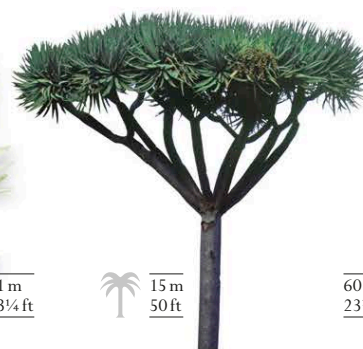
Native to Chile and Argentina, this representative of a large New World genus has pale flowers marked with fine purple stripes.

1 m  
3 3/4 ft30 cm  
12 in**FIELD GLADIOLUS***Gladiolus italicus*  
F: Iridaceae

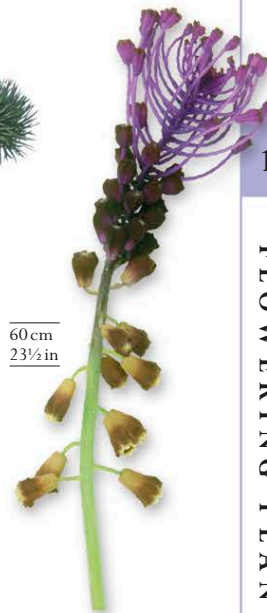
A Mediterranean member of the iris family, the field gladiolus flowers between March and June.

1 m  
3 3/4 ft**GREAT CAMAS***Camassia leichtlinii*  
F: Asparagaceae

The edible bulbs of several *Camassia* species were cooked like potatoes by Native American peoples as a staple food called Quamash.

15 m  
50 ft**DRAGON TREE***Dracaena draco*  
F: Asparagaceae

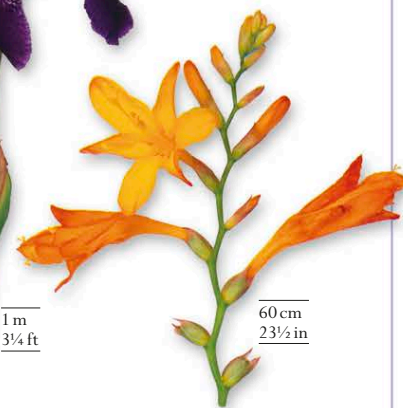
Rare in its native Canary Islands and Madeira, this many-branched tree survives as a popular ornamental. Its red sap was prized as "dragon's blood".

60 cm  
23 1/2 in**TASSEL HYACINTH***Muscari comosum*  
F: Asparagaceae

The flowerheads of this Mediterranean species have fertile and sterile flowers, the latter forming the purplish "tassel" at the top.

1 m  
3 3/4 ft**BEARDED IRIS***Iris germanica*  
F: Iridaceae

Botanists are unsure whether this fragrant-flowered garden iris was once native to the E. Mediterranean or originated as a garden hybrid.

60 cm  
23 1/2 in**MONTBRETIA***Crocsmia x crocosmiflora*  
F: Iridaceae

A 19th-century hybrid created from two South African species, this popular garden plant is invasive in some areas.

**KEW'S FREESIA***Freesia x kewensis*  
F: Iridaceae

Derived from native South African ancestors, this freesia is a sweet-smelling garden hybrid in the northern hemisphere.

60 cm  
23 1/2 in45 cm  
18 in**BARBARY NUT***Gynandriris sisyrinchium*  
F: Iridaceae

This wild Mediterranean iris grows from a corm (a bulb-like underground stem), which helps it survive unfavourable conditions.

**SAFFRON CROCUS***Crocus sativus*  
F: Iridaceae

The dried stigmas of this cultivated Mediterranean crocus have long been sold as saffron, used for colouring and flavouring food.

60 cm  
23 1/2 in**GRAND CHRISTMAS BELLS***Blandfordia grandiflora*  
F: Blandfordiaceae

Nectar-sipping birds seek out this large-flowered species of coastal E. Australia. Its leaves are narrow and grass-like.